

Weekly Writing - Week 1

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Tool, Not a Shortcut: How I Use AI in R

AI is most valuable when I treat it as a tool, not a shortcut. I start by thinking through the problem and building a minimal, reproducible example. Only then do I ask AI to help diagnose errors, debug, and propose clearer, idiomatic patterns. I never copy-paste. Instead, I integrate suggestions into my own code, annotate the why in comments, and test against edge cases.

This workflow keeps the focus where it matters—statistical reasoning, model choice, and interpretation—while reducing time lost to syntax hunting and trial-and-error debugging. Used this way, AI accelerates feedback loops, expands my vocabulary of R tools, and helps me articulate what I tried, what failed, and why the fix works. The result is cleaner code, faster iteration, and deeper understanding, with learning measured by explanations I can write, not answers I can paste.